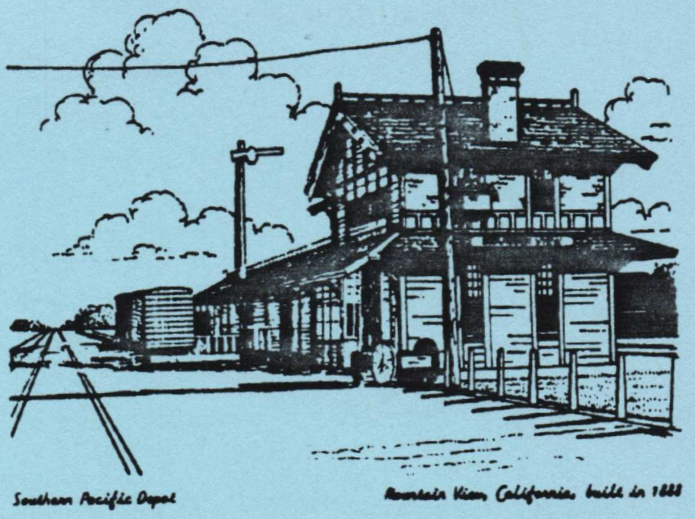
Mountain View Historical Association Newsletter

P.O. Box 252
Mountain View, CA 94042

Hilton U. Brown, III - Editor



South Los Altos
A Suburb of Mountain View
The November Meeting

Once upon a time, upstart Los Altos was considered to be a part of Mountain View. Beverly McChesney and Laura Cline have produced a video of the early history of South Los Altos, and we will have an opportunity to see the video and discuss those early days.

As usual, there will be the opportunity for light refreshments and fellowship after the presentation.

Barbecue & Raffle
The August Meeting

The Sixth Annual Barbecue & Raffle for the Mountain View Historical Association took place Sunday, August 1, 1999. The weather cooperated to provide a very pleasant afternoon. The Jehnings collaborated as usual to produce outstanding hamburgers while standing next to a very hot grill on a warm day in August. Gangs of folks pitched in to set up the patio and put things away, staff the chow line, clean up, sell tickets and take care of the necessary details. You will find a brief financial statement elsewhere in this Newsletter, as well as acknowledgment for the fine organizations whose donations helped make the Barbecue & Raffle such a pleasant event.

Mark Rogge, the City Engineer managing the restoration of the Adobe Building gave us an excellent progress report. He also pleaded with us to help in finding pictures, programs, articles and artifacts from the early days of the Adobe, which will be useful in authenticating the restoration.

Street Talk
From Barbara Kinchen

The August **Street Talk Puzzler** was: *What was Dalma Drive's previous name?*

In 1951 Jalavich Avenue was changed to Dalma Drive. The large Matthew P. Jalavich family home was on land now occupied by Calderon Shopping Center and the top story became the house now standing at Calderon and Dalma.

Let's hear from you readers. Please send information and questions about street names and locations to the Association's P.O. Box 252, Mountain View, CA 94042.

Steel Rails to Mountain View
By Nyle C. Monday

Much of the early history of nineteenth century California revolves around development of the railroads. Although they are alternately seen as either the facilitator of modern commerce or as the octopus which swallowed the land and wealth of the state, no one can deny the impact of the iron horse on the nation, the state, and even on our own locality. Mountain View, occupying an important position almost midway between San Francisco and Jose, had its own unique role in California railroad history and one which deserves to be remembered.

In an agricultural area like Santa Clara Valley, the problem of delivering produce to market has always been of primary importance. While water transport was available from Alviso and other ports along the bay, the problem of getting the crops to the ships remained, and the additional time required for loading and unloading hade railroad service seem even more attractive. Yet railroad construction required a great deal of initial capital, and even in a rich state like California it was not always easy to come up with the necessary cash.

Even so, it was not surprising that some of the movers and shakers of the growing city of San Jose began to think of the potential profit of such an endeavor. In 1851, Davis Divine, a judge in San Jose began to raise money for the construction of a San Jose to San Francisco railroad service. While the project was ultimately stillborn (in spite of the interest expressed in it by the Rothschild family), this did not discourage Divine. A year later he was back with anew company, under the grandiose title "Pacific and Atlantic Rail Road," and even began surveying the route north, part of which ran through property owned by the Castro family. Divine was soon pushed out of the project by bigger investors, but even though more capital became available, the railroad idea was again abandoned.

It was not until 1860 that a railroad route became a serious possibility once again. A professional promoter named Peter Donahue began work on a new line, the San Francisco and San Jose Railroad, and with considerable skill he began amassing the money, men and materials to make the steel highway a reality. By October 1863, this new line offered service from San Francisco to Mayfield (Palo Alto), with connecting stage service the remainder of the way into San Jose. The inaugural journey was made by city officials of San Francisco, who were seated on open flatcars and were whisked along at an amazing speed of nearly sixty miles an hour! On the 17th of that same month, a more elaborate transit was made with nearly four hundred passengers, including Governor Stanford and Governor Gibbs of Oregon.

The question remains whether the railroad proceeded only as far as Palo Alto (coincidentally the boundary of Castro property) only due to delays in construction, or whether it experienced problems gaining right-of-way over that family's land. The historical record seems to be unclear on this point. The Castro family was certainly aware of railroad practices which legally "stole" land that could not be otherwise be obtained, yet they no doubt also recognized the potential good which railroad service might bring. What is known is that by January 1864, the San Francisco and San Jose Railroad Company commenced service all the way into San Jose itself, and a deed was signed August 20 of that same year by Crisanto Castro and his mother giving right of way for a payment of $500. Along with the cash settlement, the railroad was also required to construct and maintain a station near the Castro home (located at Alma and Rengstorff Avenues) at which trains would stop twice a day, and allow any member of that family to stop any local train merely by flagging it down as long as the railroad was in existence. It is also believed that the railroad was required to build a spur line which led right up to the family's hay barn. Interestingly, this deed was signed some seven months after track was laid across their property, and it has been speculated that this delay was because the Castro's were waiting to see if the railroad would hold up their end of the bargain!

Whatever the exact nature of the agreement, right of way was granted, and Saturday, January 16, 1864, nearly two thousand people crowded into six coaches and a number of cattle and box cars on two different trains for the first regular service from San Francisco to San Jose proper. At 1:30 P.M. this merry excursion ended at the San Joses' depot to the roar of the crowd and the tunes of a brass band in a celebration which was remembered by people all along the route for many years.

Like so many other aspects of our local history, the study of the role of the railroads is one which offers many fascinating stories and much room for future research. Each day we listen and watch as trains rush through the city, but how often do we wonder how it all came about? Perhaps this brief introduction will serve to make us all stop once in a while and think of all those people, scoundrels and dreamers' alike, who

helped bring the steel rails to Mountain View.

NOTICE – DUES ARE DUE!

On your Newsletter address label you will find a number following your name. This number is the year through which your dues have been paid. Life members are indicated by the initials LM and no further dues are required of these dear people. If you are not a Life Member you should find a pre-addressed convenience envelope enclosed in your newsletter. Write your check, insert in the envelope, affix a stamp and drop it in the mail. Thank you for your continuing support!

OLD NEWSPAPER ITEMS COMPILED BY BARBARA KINCHEN

100 Years Ago (1899): San Jose's YMCA building, 82 N 2nd Street, was purchased by funds from the Sleeper Trust and dedicated as Sleeper Hall, headquarters for the Spiritualist Union of San Jose. Frank and Eunice (Beverly) Sleeper had lived in Mountain View since 1851 and Mr. Sleeper had served on the County Board of Supervisors. They were both Spiritualists and after his death in 1872, she established a trust with all proceeds, except a small yearly sum for her living expenses, to support their beliefs. Dedication ceremonies for Sleeper Hall were November 26, 1899, Mrs. Sleeper's 85th birthday. Several years later her funeral services were held there also, after which she was buried in Mountain View, as were her husband and young daughter. Sleeper, Eunice and Franklin Avenues are part of former Sleeper properties.

75 Years Ago (1924): W.C.T.U. ladies chose an individual's name for the local branch and honored a charter member, Mary Julia Gates of Calderon Avenue, for her years of loyalty and devoted service.

More than 26 hundred tons of freight were handled by South Shore Port in October. The Company operated one steamer and six trucks and had contracted for a second ship to cost $40,000.

California's only Deciduous Fruit Research and Experimental Station is located in Mountain View.

The 10th Annual Prune and Apricot Exposition featured an "Illuminated Street Parade" and Tom Dale's Riders of the Gray Sage.

Fred Jarvis was appointed to the police force as traffic officer. Another part of his job was as inspector of new sidewalks and curbs.

Minto Company advertized lots on Ehrhorn Avenue at $8.00 per front foot.

Dr. D.E. Davenport was in charge of the Mountain View Hospital and Sanitarium on the "Highway near the Castro Entrance." He had installed a c"chlorine chamber for treatment of respiratory disorders."

California Supply Company, commonly called the Pickle Factory, bought more land on Franklin Street on which to build a large factory for making dill pickles. The company located here in 1917.

Fruit cake and mince pies for holiday dinners were available at Hirschbek Bakery, 168 Castro Street.

50 Years Ago (1949): The minimum wage went from 40¢ per hour to 75¢.

Walt Keene sold the Daily Register, which he had owned since 1937, to Mr. and Mrs. Sutton Christian.

A weekend of events was planned for the 3rd annual Mexican Fiesta of Guadalupe.

The Crab Kettle, 2011 El Camino, sold three crabs for $1.00 and on Escuela Avenue William Joseph had 30 pound lugs of canning tomatoes for 50¢.

Halloween events included a Spook Parade for costumed children which was sponsored by Recreation Department and Highway School P.T.A., Dance Party at Veterans of Foreign Wars Hall on Moffett Boulevard and the theater had vaudeville acts on stage and The Spider Woman, with Bella Lugosi, on screen.

Anthony Radisich and Ivan Vojvoda organized Anrad's Travelers, a semi-professional basketball team.

Whisman District's new Crittenden School held an open house and celebrated the 89th birthday of Albert Crittenden, for whom the school is named. He was in the first class of the original Whisman School when

it was built in 1871.

New Businesses in town included Mary Ann Dress Shop at 819 Villa, Diaz & Sons Shoe Store at 200 Castro, Craig Furniture, El Camino at Ehrhorn, Sue Berry Salon and Romero's Florist Shop in the 800 blocks of Castro. Dana Washette, Mountain View Cycle and Toy shop and J. Bennett Company Stationers were all new on Dana Street. After ten years at Castro and Dana, J.C. Penney moved into a new building at 274 Castro.

After occupying three temporary locations the past year, Chamber of Commerce moved into new headquarters on Castro at Mercy, built from money willed by Mary Rose Sladky.

Pre-colored oleomargarine could be sold for the first time on October 1. Until this time it was white and you added yellow coloring for it to resemble butter.

25 Years Ago (1974): Victor Calvo was sworn in as Democratic Assemblyman for the new 21st district. Until November 30, he served on the Santa Clara County Board of Supervisors and previously was a Mountain View councilman and mayor.

The Fire Department wound up its Centennial Celebration by placing a time capsule at Fire Station Four, 231 Whisman Road. It is to be opened in 1999.

After standing in line at a local bank, a young man said to the teller, "Oh, I left it in the car." He reappeared a few moments later and showed the young lady a card with the word gun written on it. He got away with an undisclosed amount of cash in a late model convertible. Headlines read "Forgetful Bandit Comes Back."

NEW TO THE MOUNTAIN VIEW HISTORY CENTER BY BARBARA KINCHEN

From Vivian Schatz: 1950 Directory of Mountain View.

From Doroth Burr Workman of Santa Clara: School yearbooks for 1936 and 1937 and three photos: 8" x 10" 1933 graduating class, Highway Elementary School; 10" x 48" Students and teachers, Highway Elementary School, Circa 1930; 10" x 48" Hospital Staff of San Francisco Chapter American Red Cross Influenza Epidemic, November 19, 1918.

From Phyllis and Henry Milo: Wooden sign reading:

PEERLESS NURSERIES
SAN FRANCISCO ROAD
MOUNTAIN VIEW

The sign has been in their garden for years, came with the house. Our directories show nothing about this business. Does anyone have information about it?

From Lisetta Jansen Mieth Challen:
Mrs. Lisetta Jansen Mieth Challen, of Capitola, died this year and willed our Association a beautiful, large, ornate and valuable wardrobe or armoire. Mrs Challen was a great grand-daughter of Christopher Conrad Stierlin (1826-1900) and Clara Laux Stierlin (1834-1904). In 1851 Mr. Stierlin settled in the area later known as Old Mountain View. In 1864 he bought a large ranch closer to the bay on a road later named for him, Stierlin Road. The property and large were near present Shoreline Boulevard (formerly Stierlin Road), 101 Highway and L'Avenida. The Rengstorff family became their neighbors to the north.

Wally Erichsen arranged for the armoire to be moved to Mountain View and has been in contact with one of the executors who has promised to share information and pictures from boxes found in Mrs. Challen's home.

We hope to find some definite proof that the armoire was once part of the Mountain View household of Mr. and Mrs. C.C. Stierlin.

In Commemoration

Joseph Phillip Cusimano — Age 82, died July 17, 1999. Beloved husband of Margaret Cusimano (formerly Margaret Jory) and the late Emma Sue Cusimano of 49 years. Survived by children Matthew, Joseph, Sherri and Peter Cusimano and by numerous nieces, nephews and friends. Resident of San Jose since 1919 and of Mountain View since 1957. Graduate of San Jose High School, San Jose State College, California College of Mortuary Sciences. Retired Major of the U.S. Army (Medical Corps), veteran of WWII (Battle of the Bulge). 22 years in the Army Reserves. Mr. Cusimano was a Mountain View City Council member from 1968 to 1976 and served as Mayor in 1974. A member of the American Legion, Eagles and the Elks. Founder and First President of the Sierra Club of Mtn. View. A member of numerous other social, religious and service organizations. Past President of the Chamber of Commerce and Citizen of the Year in 1976. Founder (with Sue Cusimano) of the Cusimano Family Colonial Mortuary, established in 1957. Joseph Phillip Cusimano was also a member of the Mountain View Historical Association.

Reynolds W. Camp — Age 81, died August 20, 1999. Born in Palo Alto. Married Juanita Murdock in June, 1942. Survived by his wife, two sons, Dennis and David, daughter Elaine, and seven grandchildren. Mr. Camp graduated from Mountain View High School and attended Menlo College and Stanford University. He graduated from UCLA in 1941 and went on to serve as a flight instructor in the US Army Air Corps during WWII. Mr. Camp was self-employed as a real estate and insurance broker until his retirement in 1972. Mr. Camp was a founder and President of the Mtn. View Board of Realtors. Mr. Camp served on the Mtn. View Planning Commission and was Mtn. View Citizen of the Year in 1964. Reynolds W. Camp was a Life Member of the Mountain View Historical Association.

Betty Nelson Fahs — Age 83, died July 29, 1999 in Mountain View. Widow of F. Robert Fahs. She is survived by her children Barbara Fahs and Beverly Shepherd, granddaughter Jennifer Sheperd, son-in-law Steve Sheperd and her cousin Frances B. Collins. Mrs. Fahs graduated Phi Beta Kappa from the University of Wisconsin and remained active in the Alpha Chi Omega Sorority. She was honored by the Mountain View-Los Altos Union High School Division as the Senior Student of the Year in 1997. Mrs. Fahs a regular volunteer in the History Center of the Mtn. View Public Library. Betty Nelson Fahs was a member of the Mountain View Historical Association.

1999 Annual Barbecue & Raffle Donors & Contributors

The Mountain View Historical Association is grateful to the following businesses and individuals whose generosity helped make the 1999 Annual Barbecue & Raffle a great success:

Armadillo Willys
1031 N. San Antonio Road
Mtn. View, CA 94041

Baskin-Robbins
2585 W. Middlefield Road
Mtn. View, CA 94043

Baskin-Robbins
703 E. El Camino Real
Mtn. View, CA 94040

Chevys Restaurant
2116 W. El Camino Real
Mtn. View, CA 94041

Chili's
2560 El Camino Real
Mtn. View, CA 94041

Chiropractic Care
147 Castro Street
Mtn. View, CA 94041

Clarkes
615 W. El Camino Real
Mtn. View, CA 94041

Costco Wholesale
1000 N. Rengstorff Ave.
Mtn. View, CA 94043

Global Village Cafe
209 Castro Street
Mtn. View, CA 94041

In-N-Out Burgers
1159 Rengstorff Ave.
Mtn. View, CA 94043

Kapps Pizza
191 Castro Street
Mtn. View, CA 94041

Le Boulanger
650 Castro Street
Mtn. View, CA 94041

Lucky Stores
580 N. Rengstorff Ave.
Mtn. View, CA 94043

Lucky Stores
715 El Camino Real
Mtn. View, CA 94040

Minton Lumber Comp.
455 W. Evelyn
Mtn. View, CA 94041

Orchard Supply
2555 Charleston Road
Mtn. View, CA 94041

Red Rock Cafe
201 Castro Street
Mtn. View, CA 94041

Rio Grande Restaurant
228 Castro Street
Mtn. View, CA 94041

Safeway Stores
1750 Miramonte Avenue
Mtn. View, CA 94040

Safeway Stores
2589 California Street
Mtn. View, CA 94040

Safeway Stores
570 N. Shoreline Blvd.
Mtn. View, CA 94043

Star Bucks
1037 El Monte Avenue
Mtn. View, CA 94040

Sunnyvale Produce
1101 El Camino Real
Mtn. View, CA 94806

Tied House
954 Villa Street
Mtn. View, CA 94041

Wal - Mart
600 Showers Drive
Mtn. View, CA 94041

Executive Committee Meeting

The Executive Committee of the Mountain View Historical Association met September 2, 1999. The Membership and Treasurer's reports are presented elsewhere in this Newsletter.

The *History of Mountain View* project is still on schedule and on budget. There is some possibility that the City may participate directly in this project. As described in the *New To The Library* section of this Newsletter, the Association has received an antique Armoire from the Stierlin estate. The Armoire will be stored at City Hall until a permanent display location can be found.

As noted elsewhere, the Sixth Annual Barbeque & Raffle was a great success and netted the Association over $800.00. Mark Rogge of the City Staff gave a fine presentation, bringing us all up-to-date on the Adobe. Project.

Sixth Annual Barbeque & Raffle Accounting

August 1, 1999

Income:	73 @ $10.00	$ 730.00	
	Raffle	278.00	
	Cash Donations	11.00	
	Total		$1,019.00
Expenses:	Charcoal	$ 7.00	
	Flyers & Postage		201.31
	Total		208.31
Profit:			$ 810.69

Don't Forget to Vote! Tuesday November 2, 1999

Farewell

A.J. De Larios has been the Treasurer of the Mountain View Historical Association since the fall of 1994. Five long years. June has kept the books, written the checks, deposited our income, managed our investments and rendered up the quarterly financial statement in a timely and suitable form. She now moves on to other Volunteer work. I will miss her, particularly because I've been assigned to pick up her tasks as Treasurer, at least on an interim basis. Anyone out there that would like to be Treasurer?

When June undertook the Treasurer's role she had the promise of help from a computer savvy person. That person has been called away, leaving June to struggle by hand with our books. The straw that really gave June pause were those little surprise packages from Washington and Sacramento demanding instantaneous response to questions straight out of left field. But June coped admirably. Thanks June, for five years of conscientious effort and cheerful goodwill.

Yours,
Editor and Treasurer, Hilton U. Brown, III

Membership Report
by Edna Thompson

A list of members of the Mountain View Historical Association is available to members from the Chair of the Membership Committee. Dues are $ 7.00 per year for an individual or $10.00 per year for a family, and Life Membership is $100.00 per person.

Life Members	66
Special Member	1
Honored Member	1
Individual and Family Members	210
Total	278

New Member:
Carlene Thompson Cheetham

New Life Members:
Mary Ann Meek Buswell
R. Michael Kasperzak
Nancy Noe

Association Officers and Board Members

President	Ralph Faravelli
Past President & Social	Wally Erichsen
Vice President & Program	John Viscovich
Secretary	Eva Mockbee
Treasurer	June de Larios
Membership, Memorials And Remembrances	Edna Thompson
Newsletter	Hilton Brown
Hospitality	Elizabeth Engberg
" " "	Margaret Peterson
Ways & Means	Joseph Sweeney
Historical Data	Barbara Kinchen
Amplification/Recording	Albert Jehning

Regular meetings of the Mountain View Historical Association are held on the first Sunday of February, May, August and November. The Newsletter is mailed approximately two weeks before each meeting. Deadline for copy for the Newsletter is the third Sunday before each meeting. Short items on appropriate topics submitted by any member of the Association will be considered for publication.

Life Members
As of September 30, 1999

Mario Ambra
Marge Hingsberger Bailey
Godfrey Baumgartner
Dena K. Bonnell
Flora Brown
Hilton Brown
Mary Ann Meek Buswell
Cliff Del Carlo
Alfred P. Chasuk
Doris Ebere
Ruth Erichsen
Wallace Erichsen
Carmen Farvelli
Ralph Faravelli
Roger Fellows
Patricia Figueroa
Carole Fischer
Tom Frankum
Marion Grimm
Estelle Stagg Heffelfinger
Bill Henderson
Ed Henderson
Eleanor McGlynn Henderson
Charles Hirschbek
Norene Hogle
Alice D. Holden
George Holden
Donald M. Holt
Virginia M. Holt
George Jagels
Harold Jarvis
R. Michael Kasperzak
Al Jehning
Robert W. Kirby
Joe Kleitman
Helen Shearer Krogh
Holly Urban Moore Leonard
Madeline Chargon Malovos
Frances Churin Mills
Eva Mockbee
Gail Urban Moore
LaVerna Vincent Morgan
Mimi Mourkas
Anne G. Nichols
Nancy Noe
Milan Popovich
John P. Puppo
Patricia J. Reyburn
Elaine Marcetti Shearer
Nancy L. Smith
Richard M. Smith
Martin J. Spangler
Honor Spitz
J. R. Stafford
Brigitte Stafford
H. Lee Stillens
Linda Swan
Joseph Sweeney
Roberta Sweeney
Edna Thompson
Sally Moore Taboada
John Viscovich
Arthur Walton
Patricia Walton
Denise Williams
Bill Wissell

Treasurer's Report
By A.J. de Larios
July 1, 1999 - September 30, 1999

Balance 7/1/99		$ 11,244.12
Income		
Membership	$ 248.00	
Sales	29.60	
Barbecue	1,019.00	
Adobe	200.00	
Interest	878.40	
Total Income		$ 2,375.00
Expenses		
Administration	$ 388.70	
Adobe	558.83	
Barbecue	208.31	
Total Expenses		$ 1,155.84
Balance 9/30/99		$ 12,463.28
Fund Balances		
Adobe Fund	$ 883.43	
Memorial Fund	400.00	
Life Member Fund	6,600.00	
General Fund	4,579.85	
Total Funds		$ 12,463.28

MOUNTAIN VIEW HISTORICAL ASSOCIATION
REGULAR MEETING

Sunday, November 7, 1999
2:00 PM
Senior Center - 266 Escuela

Topic and Speakers
South Los Altos
A Suburb of Mountain View

Presented by

Beverley McChesney
&
Laura Cline

MEMBERSHIP: Any person who signifies interest in the aims of this Association and who pays the specified annual dues may become a member of the Association.

AIMS: The aims of this Association are: to gather and preserve historical data relative to the early settlement and development of the area in and around the present City of Mountain View; to collect, record, edit and publish a history of the pioneering activities of this area; to preserve historic objects and places; to cooperate with other organizations in the Santa Clara Valley on projects deemed worthy by our membership.

MEMBERSHIP APPLICATION

NAME: _____

ADDRESS: _____

_____

_____

TELEPHONE: _____

TYPE: NEW____ RENEWAL____
Regular Member $ 7.00/yr
Family Membership $10.00/yr
Life Member $100.00.

Make Check Payable to:
Mountain View Historical Association
P.O. Box 252, Mountain View, CA 94042

MOUNTAIN VIEW
HISTORICAL ASSOCIATION
P.O. BOX 252
MOUNTAIN VIEW, CA 94042





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